

Absolutely — **“breathe”** is a useful target because your passage uses it in:

> “Gardening gives her a chance to slow down and **“breathe”**.”

Here **“breathe”** can be read both literally and figuratively: literally, **“to take air into and out of the lungs”**; figuratively, **“to pause, relax, and get some mental space after being busy or stressed”**.

Word family: **“breathe / breath / breathing / breathless / breathlessly”**

“Base verb:” breathe

“Noun:” breath

“-ing form / noun:” breathing

“Related adjective:” breathless

“Adverb:” breathlessly

“Useful expressions:” take a breath, catch one’s breath, hold one’s breath, out of breath, breathe deeply

“Part of speech:” verb (動詞) / noun family (名詞詞族)

Your sentence:

> “Gardening gives her a chance to slow down and **“breathe”**.”

Meaning in your passage: **“breathe = pause and relax / regain calm — 喘口氣；放鬆一下”**

Here **“breathe”** does not merely describe the automatic biological act of respiration. It also suggests:

> **“taking a pause from a busy, stressful pace and allowing oneself to relax physically and mentally.”**

“繁體中文：”

“從忙碌或壓力中稍作停頓，讓自己喘口氣、放鬆下來”

Natural translation:

> “Gardening gives her a chance to slow down and breathe.”

「做園藝讓她有機會**放慢腳步，喘口氣、放鬆一下**。」

So here:

> **“breathe = 喘口氣；放鬆身心”**

1. **breathe** = take air into and out of the lungs (生理) — 呼吸

The core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “Try to **breathe** slowly.”

「試著慢慢**呼吸**。」

Practice 2

> “Fish cannot breathe out of water for long.”

「魚離開水後不能長時間**呼吸**。」

breathe = 把空氣吸入肺部，再呼出體外

2. **breathe deeply** (呼吸) — 深呼吸

Practice 3

> “**Breathe deeply** and relax your shoulders.”

「**深呼吸**，然後放鬆肩膀。」

Practice 4

> “She stopped for a moment and **breathed deeply**.”

「她停了一會兒，做了幾次**深呼吸**。」

breathe deeply = 吸入較多空氣並較充分地呼出

3. **breathe** = pause / relax figuratively (比喻) — 喘口氣；稍作放鬆

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 5 — Original

> “Gardening gives her a chance to slow down and **breathe**.”

「園藝讓她有機會放慢腳步，**喘口氣、放鬆一下**。」

Practice 6

> “After a stressful morning, I just need a few minutes to breathe.”

「忙亂了一個早上後，我只需要幾分鐘**喘口氣、冷靜一下**。」

Practice 7

> “The weekend finally gave us space to breathe.”

「週末終於讓我們有空間**放鬆一下、喘口氣**。」

****breathe — figurative = 暫時離開壓力或忙碌狀態，重新獲得平靜和空間****

4. ****breathe = inhale/exhale a substance (吸入 / 呼出) — 吸入；呼出****

Practice 8

> “Do not ****breathe**** the smoke.”

「不要****吸入****那些煙。」

Practice 9

> “She breathed warm air onto her hands.”

「她把暖氣****呼到****手上。」

****breathe + substance = 吸入或呼出某種氣體 / 空氣****

5. ****breathe = say something very softly (說話) — 低聲說；輕聲吐出****

A literary but established sense.

Practice 10

> “‘Thank you,’ she ****breathed****.”

「『謝謝你，』她****輕聲說道****。」

Practice 11

> “He breathed her name quietly.”

「他**低聲念出**她的名字。」

breathe — literary = 用很輕、很柔的聲音說出話語

6. **breathe = allow air to pass through (物料) — 透氣**

A common material/fabric sense.

Practice 12

> “This fabric **breathes** well.”

「這種布料很**透氣**。」

Practice 13

> “Leather needs to breathe.”

「皮革需要**透氣**。」

breathe — material = 讓空氣或水蒸氣能夠通過，避免過度悶熱或潮濕

7. **breathe = give life/freshness to something (比喻) — 注入生氣；使煥然一新**

A useful figurative sense.

Practice 14

> “The new plants **breathed life into** the balcony.”

「新植物為露台**注入了生氣**。」

Practice 15

> “Her ideas breathed new life into the project.”

「她的想法為這個項目**注入了新的活力**。」

****breathe life into = 令某事重新變得有活力、有趣或有生命力****

8. ****breath = air taken into/out of lungs — 一口氣；呼吸****

The core noun.

Practice 16

> “Take a deep ****breath****.”

「****深吸一口氣****。」

Practice 17

> “His breath was visible in the cold air.”

「寒冷空氣中可以看到他呼出的****氣息****。」

****breath = 一次吸入或呼出的空氣，或呼吸本身****

Important spelling/pronunciation distinction:

* ****breathe**** = verb

* ****breath**** = noun

They are closely related but different words.

9. ****take a breath (固定搭配) — 吸一口氣；喘口氣****

Practice 18

> “Take a ****breath**** before you answer.”

「回答前先****吸一口氣 / 喘口氣****。」

Practice 19

> “She paused to take a breath.”

「她停下來****喘了一口氣****。」

****take a breath = 吸一口氣，或短暫停頓一下****

10. ****catch one's breath (呼吸) — 喘過氣來；恢復呼吸****

Practice 20

> “He stopped running to ****catch his breath****.”

「他停下跑步，讓自己****喘過氣來****。」

Practice 21

> “Give me a minute to catch my breath.”

「給我一分鐘，讓我****喘口氣****。」

****catch one's breath = 在劇烈活動或驚訝後恢復正常呼吸****

11. ****hold one's breath (呼吸) — 屏住呼吸****

Practice 22

> “She ****held her breath**** underwater.”

「她在水下****屏住呼吸****。」

Practice 23

> “Hold your breath for a few seconds.”

「****屏住呼吸****幾秒。」

****hold one's breath = 暫時停止吸氣和呼氣****

12. ****hold one's breath (比喻) — 緊張等待；屏息以待****

Practice 24

> “Everyone ****held their breath**** as the results were announced.”

「公布結果時，大家都**屏息以待**。」

Practice 25

> “We held our breath waiting for the final decision.”

「我們**緊張地等待**最終決定。」

hold one's breath — figurative = 因緊張、期待或焦慮而非常專注地等待

13. **out of breath (呼吸) — 上氣不接下氣；氣喘吁吁**

Practice 26

> “I was **out of breath** after climbing the stairs.”

「爬完樓梯後我**氣喘吁吁**。」

Practice 27

> “She arrived out of breath.”

「她到達時**上氣不接下氣**。」

out of breath = 因運動、奔跑等而呼吸急促，暫時喘不過氣

14. **breathing = act/process of breathing — 呼吸**

Practice 28

> “Her **breathing** became slower.”

「她的**呼吸**變慢了。」

Practice 29

> “Deep breathing can help some people relax.”

「**深呼吸**可以幫助一些人放鬆。」

breathing = 呼吸這個生理過程

15. **breathing space** (比喻) — 喘息空間；緩衝餘地

A very useful figurative extension.

Practice 30

> “The deadline extension gave us some **breathing space**.”

「延長期限給了我們一些**喘息空間 / 緩衝時間**。」

Practice 31

> “She needs more breathing space in her schedule.”

「她的日程需要更多**喘息空間**。」

breathing space = 暫時減輕壓力、讓人有時間恢復或重新安排的空間 / 餘地

16. **breathless** = unable to breathe normally after effort — 氣喘吁吁的

Practice 32

> “She was **breathless** after running upstairs.”

「她跑上樓後**氣喘吁吁**。」

Practice 33

> “The climb left us **breathless**.”

「爬山令我們**喘不過氣來**。」

breathless = 因運動或勞累而呼吸急促、難以正常呼吸的

17. **breathless** = extremely excited / tense (比喻) — 屏息的；極度興奮 / 緊張的

Practice 34

> “The audience waited in **breathless silence**.”

「觀眾在**屏息般的寂靜**中等待。」

Practice 35

> “She gave a breathless account of what happened.”

「她**激動得幾乎喘不過氣般**講述事情經過。」

****breathless — figurative = 因興奮、緊張或急切而顯得呼吸急促、語氣急促****

18. ****breathlessly = while breathing fast / excitedly — 氣喘吁吁地；激動地****

Practice 36

> “He spoke ****breathlessly**** after running into the room.”

「他跑進房間後****氣喘吁吁地****說話。」

Practice 37

> “She **breathlessly** told us the news.”

「她****激動而急促地****把消息告訴我們。」

****breathlessly = 以呼吸急促或極度興奮的狀態做某事****

Important distinction: ****breathe vs breath****

This is the biggest learner trap.

****breathe****

verb:

> “Breathe slowly.”

「慢慢呼吸。」

****breath****

noun:

> “Take a deep breath.”

「深吸一口氣。」

So:

> breathe = 呼吸

> breath = 一口氣 / 呼吸

Important distinction: **breathe** vs **breathless**

breathe

= perform respiration.

breathless

= breathing with difficulty/rapidly, or figuratively intensely excited.

> “I can breathe normally.”

> “I’m breathless after running.”

Very different functions.

Important distinction: **breathe** vs **relax**

breathe

literally:

= 呼吸

figuratively:

= 喘口氣、暫時放鬆

relax

= 放鬆身心

In your sentence, **slow down and breathe** is more vivid than simply **relax** because it evokes physically pausing and taking air.

Important distinction: ****breathe vs rest****

****rest****

= stop activity to recover.

****breathe****

figuratively:

= pause long enough to regain calm/space.

Someone can rest physically while still feeling mentally tense; ****breathe**** in figurative use often suggests release from pressure.

Important distinction: ****breathe vs inhale / exhale****

****breathe****

covers the whole process.

****inhale****

= breathe in.

****exhale****

= breathe out.

So:

> breathe = 呼吸

> inhale = 吸氣

> exhale = 呼氣

Important distinction: ****breath vs breathing****

****breath****

= one breath / air expelled or inhaled.

****breathing****

= ongoing process of respiration.

> “Take a breath.”

= 吸一口氣。

> “Her breathing is slow.”

= 她的呼吸很慢。

Important distinction: ****catch one's breath vs take a breath****

****take a breath****

= deliberately inhale / pause briefly.

****catch one's breath****

= recover normal breathing after exertion/shock.

> take a breath before speaking

> vs

> catch your breath after running

Important distinction: ****breathing space vs space****

****space****

general room/time.

****breathing space****

specifically:

a temporary reduction in pressure allowing recovery or adjustment.

> “I need more time.”

neutral.

> “I need some breathing space.”

= 我需要一點**喘息餘地**。

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **breathe — respiration** = 呼吸
* **breathe deeply** = 深呼吸
* **breathe — figurative pause** = 喘口氣 / 放鬆
* **breathe + substance** = 吸入 / 呼出
* **breathe — speak softly** = 低聲說，較文學
* **breathe — material** = 透氣
* **breathe life into** = 注入生氣 / 活力
* **breath** = 一口氣 / 氣息
* **take a breath** = 吸一口氣 / 喘口氣
* **catch one's breath** = 喘過氣來
* **hold one's breath — literal** = 屏住呼吸
* **hold one's breath — figurative** = 屏息以待
* **out of breath** = 氣喘吁吁
* **breathing** = 呼吸過程
* **breathing space** = 喘息空間
* **breathless — physical** = 喘不過氣 / 氣喘吁吁
* **breathless — figurative** = 極度興奮 / 緊張
* **breathlessly** = 氣喘吁吁地 / 激動地

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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breathe — literal	把空氣吸入肺部，再呼出體外
breathe — figurative	從忙碌、壓力或緊張中稍作停頓並重新放鬆
breathe + substance	吸入或呼出某種氣體 / 空氣
breathe — literary speech	用很輕、柔的聲音說出某些話
breathe — material	讓空氣 / 水蒸氣可以通過；透氣
breathe life into	令某事重新變得有活力、有趣或有生命力
breath	一次吸入 / 呼出的空氣；一口氣
take a breath	吸一口氣，或短暫停頓一下
catch one's breath	在劇烈活動或驚訝後恢復正常呼吸
hold one's breath	暫時停止呼吸；亦可比喻緊張等待
out of breath	因運動等而呼吸急促、氣喘吁吁
breathing	呼吸這個持續的生理過程

breathing space	暫時減輕壓力、讓人恢復或重新安排的時間 / 空間	
breathless — physical	呼吸急促、難以正常呼吸的	
breathless — figurative	因興奮、緊張或急切而顯得呼吸急促 / 語氣急促的	
breathlessly	以呼吸急促或非常激動的方式	

For your original sentence

> “Gardening gives her a chance to slow down and **breathe**.”

The exact meaning is:

breathe = 不只是生理上的呼吸，而是從忙碌生活中暫停一下、喘口氣、讓自己平靜下來

So naturally:

> **「她的工作很忙，而做園藝讓她有機會放慢腳步、喘口氣、放鬆一下。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **breathe** → 呼吸
- > **breath** → 一口氣 / 氣息
- > **take a breath** → 吸一口氣 / 喘口氣
- > **catch one's breath** → 喘過氣來
- > **out of breath** → 氣喘吁吁
- > **breathing space** → 喘息空間
- > **breathe life into** → 注入活力